Use an IDE: Some of the well-known IDE's for PHP are NetBeans, phpDesigner, phpStorm, PHP Introduction and Resources.

Use a PHP Framework: A lot can be learned about PHP by experimenting with PHP frameworks. It helps PHP developers to grow themselves. Most of the PHP frameworks are designed on the basis of Model-View Controller architecture. Some of the best PHP frameworks are CakePHP, CodeIgniter, Zend, Symfony.

Use Objects (or OOP): Objects are the key points of Object-oriented programming (OOP). Some key features of OOP are

- Abstract data types and information hiding
- Inheritance
- Polymorphism

All these can be done in PHP. Developer should try to achieve this for breaking their code into separate sections based on the logic and reducing redundancy.

Should handle all possible scenarios: If some application has user interaction, then it is taking some input from the user. In such a situation, a developer should cover all the cases including the negative scenarios. For example, if a form in PHP is taking username and password from user, user may put wrong data or wrong type of data. For that, a validation procedure should be there in the code.

All these set of informal rules are learned over time for improving software quality. It is solely depending on the developers how they will make use of these guidelines. It has been consistently observed that when someone follows these guidelines properly the numbers of bugs found in that code reduces significantly. Also, it makes the code easy-to-debug. Finally, we can conclude that superior coding techniques and programming practices along with the technical knowledge are the key to success in this world of software development.